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In Nonprofits We Trust? A Large-Scale Study on the Public's Trust in Nonprofit Organizations

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ABSTRACT

Nonprofit organizations highly depend on the public's trust for legitimacy and support, to ultimately further their missions. Despite its high importance, little is known about the trust-building processes of the general public. In this study, we develop and test a multilevel study design to provide deeper insights into the public's trust in nonprofit organizations and its relevant determinants. We used a comprehensive data set of 4,072 dyads, with survey data from 1,686 individuals and organizational data related to 102 German NPOs to investigate the different trust-building components: (1) individual public trust evaluation in NPO, (2) individual (trustor) context, and (3) organizational (trustee) context. The results of the analysis reveal unexpected differences in the importance of the different components for explaining the public's trust in nonprofit organizations. Results show that the individual context is as relevant as the individual public trust evaluation, but the organizational context is far less important.

KEYWORDS

Public trust; trust building; determinants of trust; nonprofit marketing; multilevel analysis

Introduction

“Despite the diversity among NPOs, there is one thing that they have in common—public trust is their most valuable asset” (Kearns, 2014, p. 265). On the one hand, many nonprofit organizations depend highly on the public's trust because only a well-trusted organization receives social support in the form of monetary and voluntary contributions (e.g., Alhidari et al., 2018; Furneaux & Wymer, 2015; Hager & Hedberg, 2016; O'Neill, 2009). From a public's perspective, the output of nonprofit organizations is difficult to quantify unambiguously (Willems, Jegers, & Faulk, 2016), and the mission orientation leads to stakeholders relying heavily on relational trust in their interactions with nonprofit organizations (Kearns, 2014). On the other hand, the nonprofit sector maintains its status as the most trusted one (Edelman, 2019; Laidler-Kylander, Quelch, & Simonin, 2007). Due to the non-distribution constraint, according to which nonprofits are not allowed to distribute profit to private parties, the public ascribes them higher levels of trustworthiness compared to other institutions or sectors (Hansmann,

1980). A growing number of scandals in nonprofit sectors worldwide, however, challenges the notion of inherent nonprofit trust (Prakash & Gugerty, 2010). Recent incidences in some of the most respected organizations such as WWF International's allegations of human rights violations or Oxfam's Haiti scandal severely threaten public's perceptions of nonprofit organizations (Chisolm, 2008; Rimington, 2018; Willems & Faulk, 2019). Not only do these scandals harm the reputation and trustworthiness of the single organization concerned, they cause negative spillover effects also to other organizations in the sector (Archambeault & Webber, 2018; Slatten, Guidry, & Austin, 2011).

Given its high importance, research on trust in nonprofit organizations has gained growing interest among scholars over the past years. Beginning with discussions on the general significance and role of trust in the nonprofit sector (Hansmann, 2003; Ortmann & Schlesinger, 2003; Rose-Ackerman, 1996), nonprofit scholars recently focused on specific stakeholder groups centering donor trust, and its relationship with outcomes such as donor commitment (MacMillan, Money, Money, & Downing, 2005; Naskrent & Siebelt, 2011; Sargeant & Lee, 2004), or donation behavior (Hager & Hedberg, 2016; Sargeant & Lee, 2004). In another recently published study, Knapp, Sprinkle, Urick, and Delaney-Klinger (2019) evaluate the trusting behavior among the internal stakeholder group of employees of nonprofit organizations.

In contrast, less is known about the public's trust in nonprofit organizations (Bryce, 2007), and "[...] prevailing theoretical discussion and empirical study of the effects of trust suffer from confusion over different dimensions of trust" (Hager & Hedberg, 2016, p. 164). Herein, the very same approaches to address both donor and public trust have been used, which equates the general public with nonprofit stakeholders that are directly related to the organization through actual experiences and transactions, and stronger relationships, respectively (Boenigk, 2014). Sargeant and Lee (2002, p. 81), however, find empirical evidence that "trust may operate at two levels distinguishing donors from non-donors", leading to a corresponding need for differentiated marketing and management approaches (Sargeant, 2009). This study goes beyond this rather narrow perspective, and a (more or less) established trust relationship between a donor, volunteer, or beneficiary and a nonprofit organization, but focuses on the public as a specific non-relational trust reference.

The latest trend in trust research relates to the development of strategies and tools for organizational trust-building (Bekkers, 2003; Farwell, Shier, & Handy, 2018; Prakash & Gugerty, 2010). Particularly, nonprofit governance and accountability approaches are emerging that seek to send signals of quality and trustworthiness to an increasingly skeptical public (Slatten et al., 2011). Feng, Neely, and Slatten (2016) and Becker (2018), for example, provide empirical evidence for the benefits of voluntary nonprofit accountability in the form of using accreditation tools, in terms of evoking higher levels of public trust toward nonprofit organizations. However, still little is known about what determines public perceptions of

trust in organizations (Jones & Shah, 2015), and the organizational determinants have been most prominent in prior research. This study seeks to better understand the public's trust in organizations, thereby questioning the effectiveness of organizational efforts alone to build and restore the public's trust. From the fundraising literature, for instance, we know that various individual factors, including religion, gender or education are important determinants for pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations (Bekkers & Wiepking, 2011; Wiepking & Bekkers, 2012; Wymer, 2012). In this study, we thus include the context of both parties involved in the trust process, namely the trustor (individuals of the general public) and the trustee (nonprofit organization), thereby providing a more comprehensive perspective on trust.

Considering these gaps in nonprofit trust research, we aim to provide deeper insights into the trust-building processes among the general public and the relevant determinants that explain the public's trust in nonprofit organizations. Thus, our first research question is:

RQ 1: How is trust built among the general public, and which components are most important to explain public's trust in nonprofit organizations?

To answer this question, we conducted a large multilevel study with survey data from 1,686 respondents and organizational data related to 102 nonprofit organizations. Assuming that both organizational and individual determinants are somewhat important, our second research question is:

RQ 2: Which of the individual and organizational determinants explain the public's trust in a nonprofit organization most?

In the next section, we provide a literature review that leads in to our proposed public trust framework, with its different trust-building determinants. The framework builds on the combination of two theoretical perspectives: attribution theory (Kelley, 1967; see also Geigenmüller & Greschuchna, 2011) and social identity theory (Tajfel & Turner, 1979; see also Fehrler & Kosfeld, 2013), and allows for a holistic view on the public's trust in nonprofit organizations. We then show the most trusted nonprofit organizations and test various influential determinants of public trust in a nonprofit organization with the use of multilevel modeling. Finally, we discuss the findings and provide nonprofit scholars and marketers with deeper insights into the mechanisms behind the public's trust in nonprofit organizations, and approaches to successfully build and maintain public trust.

Theoretical foundation and hypotheses

Public trust framework

Previous studies from organizational science mostly conceptualized and measured trust in (nonprofit) organizations as a two-dimensional construct. The first dimension relates to positive expectations of trustworthiness (Morgan & Hunt, 1994). In this domain, scholars refer to generally positive trust-related expectations such as ability/competence, benevolence, and integrity/honesty of an organization. The second dimension is the willingness to accept vulnerability, which comes with an element of risk. Widely used across the research community, we draw on a definition that explicitly focuses on the first dimension. Specifically, we refer to Morgan and Hunt's conceptualization of trust as "existing when one party has confidence in an exchange partner's reliability and integrity" (1994, p. 23). We also integrate Feldheim and Wang's (2004) notion that public trust is based primarily on each interaction between the individual stakeholder and the nonprofit organization but ultimately is an aggregate, reflecting the attitudes of the overall public toward a nonprofit organization. To sum up, trust is thus based on the anticipated capacity of the nonprofit organization to satisfy each individual stakeholder's expectation regarding reliability, credibility and general reputation (Aurier & N'Goala, 2010).

Based on this definition, Figure 1 shows the developed framework of public trust in a nonprofit organization in an overview. Our conceptual framework builds on the assumption that the public's trust in nonprofit organizations depends on the aggregation of each individual's trust evaluation, as well as organizational and individual trust-building determinants. It follows that to provide a holistic view of public trust in nonprofit organizations, each of the aforementioned components (or methodologically speaking: levels) needs to be considered. In the following subsections, we discuss the underlying rationale for the framework and derive specific hypotheses.

Importance of three different components for explaining public's trust

Most studies on trust in nonprofit organizations center the individual trust evaluation toward a nonprofit organization, focusing on the individual as a donor (e.g. MacMillan et al., 2005; Naskrent & Siebelt, 2011). On the contrary, in our framework the individual stems from the general public with no strong direct relationship with the organization through actual experiences and transactions. If no strong relationship between an individual and a specific organization exists yet, attribution theory is one common theoretical foundation that argues that specific attributions about the organization, in particular about its trustworthiness, are the most relevant factor to build up trust (Geigenmüller & Greschuchna, 2011). If

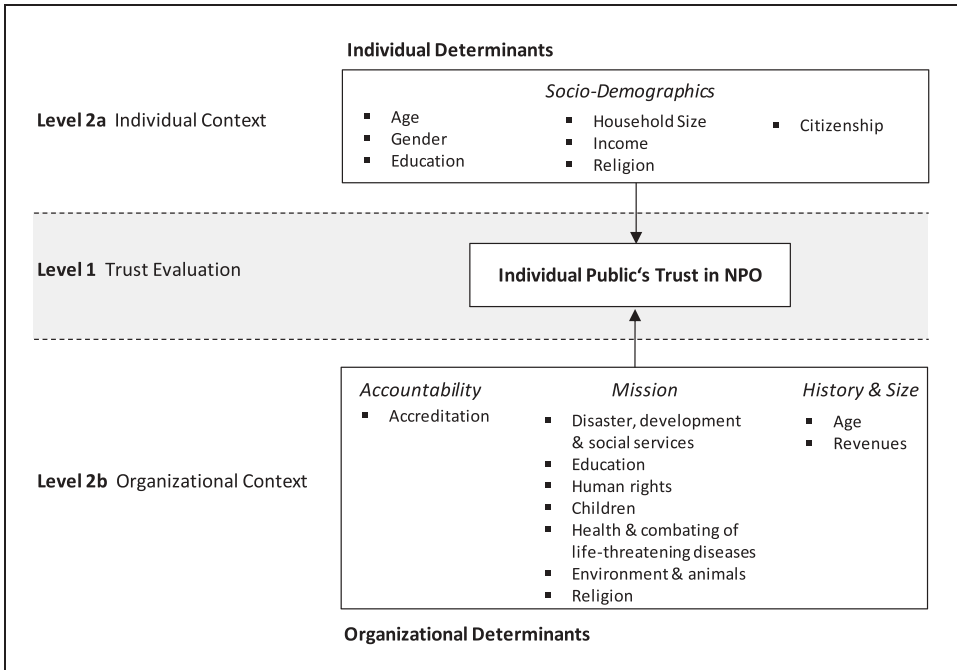


Figure 1. Public trust framework.

the individual's expectations of the organization's trustworthiness are positive, and he or she is willing to enter into an uncertain exchange relationship with the organization, trust is primed to develop (Schilke & Cook, 2013; Schoorman, Mayer, & Davis, 2007). Therefore, the core of public trust in a nonprofit organization is an aggregate of trust evaluations that each individual has made toward the nonprofit organization. Thus, our first hypothesis is the following:

Hypothesis 1. The individual trust evaluation has the largest influence on the public's trust in a nonprofit organization, compared to the individual (trustor) and the organizational (trustee) context.

In addition to the trust evaluation, there is evidence about the significance of the individual (trustor) and organizational (trustee) context in determining the public's trust in nonprofit organizations. Focusing on the individual context, the underlying rationale is that trust should vary across relationships and within persons (Schoorman et al., 2007), and trust evaluations vary strongly within individuals. According to social identity theory (Tajfel & Turner, 1979), the individual context including socio-demographics relates closely to the individuals' social identity, which helps individuals define themselves according to their group affiliations, such that it also helps them evaluate their relationships. It then follows that

individual social identity affects trust relationships with organizations, insofar as individuals value those nonprofit organizations better that embody their social identities (Ashforth & Mael, 1989). We, therefore, hypothesize, as follows:

Hypothesis 2. The individual (trustor) context has a positive influence on the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.

Social identity theory further explains that individuals possess greater trust in nonprofit organizations if they could highly identify with the organizational context, and its values and missions. Herein, attribution theory among cue utilization theory (Kelley, 1967; see also Geigenmüller & Greschuchna, 2011) provides a valuable framework for explaining the process of how individuals attribute trustworthiness to nonprofit organizations. That is, individuals assess a variety of intrinsic and extrinsic cues, and thereby derive expectations about the future organizational trustworthiness. In situations where a strong relationship has not developed yet and prior experiences with the nonprofit organization are lacking, extrinsic cues in the form of NPO-related attributes such as accountability or mission focus provide essential orientation (Geigenmüller & Greschuchna, 2011). Therefore, our third hypothesis is the following:

Hypothesis 3. The organizational (trustee) context has a positive influence on the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.

Influence of individual and organizational determinants on public's trust

For both the individual and organizational context, prior research, respectively, claimed specific determinants to be of particular relevance in the context of affecting public's trust; they are explained in the following.

Individual determinants

Individual determinants refer to the specific personal background of each person, reflected in *sociodemographics*. With an extensive literature review, Bekkers and Wiepking (2011) and Wiepking and Bekkers (2012) identify a wide range of evidence of the importance of sociodemographic characteristics for pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations, and so in trust-related relationships, including age, gender, education, household size, income, religion, and citizenship. Against the background of general trusting behavior, an early study from Stolle (1998) shows, for example, that more educated people tend to generally trust more, and that different age groups across different countries trust less or more, respectively (Niemininen et al., 2008; Stolle, 1998). In another study, Delhey and Newton (2005) provide

evidence for the impact of the religious background on the individual trusting propensity. We, therefore, hypothesize, as follows:

Hypothesis 4. Individual determinants in the form of sociodemographics influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.

Organizational determinants

Academic research has particularly highlighted three organizational determinants – accountability, mission, and history & size – that are relevant to public trust. *Accountability*: In Germany, nonprofit organizations are not obliged to report their annual financial statements publicly, though such forms of accountability are crucial to maintaining the public's trust (Greiling, 2007). Feng et al. (2016) and Becker (2018) furthermore show that external mechanisms, such as accreditation systems, can enhance public's trust in nonprofit organizations. Therefore, organizations increasingly devote efforts to demonstrating their transparency and trustworthiness with various labels, certifications, and other accreditation tools (Bekkers, 2003; Farwell et al., 2018; Furneaux & Wymer, 2015). A prestigious, nationally endorsed donor accreditation might affect trust relationships.

Mission

A nonprofit organization's mission identifies its long-term objective and determines its strategic direction (McDonald, 2007), and is thus also relevant to public trust. Missions can vary greatly across organizations, with substantially different meanings and relevance for various stakeholders (Willems, Jegers, & Faulk, 2016). For example, religiousness in a mission can have distinct impacts on people's trust (Fehrler & Kosfeld, 2013; Wiepking & Bekkers, 2012). Social identity theory suggests that when people have a special interest in a particular topic, such as the environmental sector or children's welfare, they identify more strongly with organizations that make these topics part of their mission and are more likely to support organizations with missions that reflect those connections (Fehrler & Kosfeld, 2013; James & Wiepking, 2008).

History and size

The history and size of the nonprofit organization (i.e., organization's age and revenues) also appear crucial for trust. The organization's age provides information about how established and historically anchored it is, such that age likely informs the organization's trustworthiness (Wiedmann, Hennigs, Schmidt, & Wuestefeld, 2011). Growth by an organization also signals to external stakeholders that it has been successful and that others trust and support this organization. In addition, organizational size in the form of total revenues (depending on the specific nonprofit organization; e.g. public funds,

private donations, or profitable private-nonprofit-partnerships) provides information about the efficiency and success of the nonprofit organization (Furneaux & Wymer, 2015). Such information then support conclusions about the current state of the nonprofit organization and its future forecasts. Taken all organizational determinants together, we therefore predict:

Hypothesis 5a-c. Organizational determinants – (a) accountability, (b) mission, and (c) history & size – influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.

Method

Data collection and sample

Our data set includes survey data from 1,686 respondents and organizational data related to the 102 best known nonprofit organizations in Germany (see [Appendix](#)). The first part of our data set, the individual survey data, is extracted from a larger brand equity study (Boenigk, 2014). In that study, nonprofit brand equity is conceptualized as having three dimensions, and trust is one focal concept besides two other concepts, awareness and commitment. In this study, we solely focus on the public's trust toward nonprofit brands. Data collection took place in 2015. The selection included both national and regional nonprofit organizations and covered a broad spectrum of organizational missions. In a first step, respondents (the general public) could indicate, from the full list of 102 nonprofit organizations, which ones they already had heard of (awareness level). In a comparative evaluation, they then evaluated the trustworthiness of up to three of the nonprofit organizations they were familiar with, which resulted in 4,072 evaluations toward 102 nonprofit organizations. Considering the relative context in which evaluations are made is important because individuals trust in nonprofit organizations relative to other organizations, and on the basis of comparisons. Comparative evaluations provide a more realistic perspective, such that when a reputational scandal harms the trustworthiness of one nonprofit organization, negative spill-over effects often exist for other, similar organizations (Archambeault & Webber, 2018; Slatten et al., 2011). In the framework, we hence integrated a comparative element. These methodological considerations are consistent with recommendations for comparative evaluations in organizational and marketing science (Olsen, 2002). To limit the trust evaluations to three per individual was necessary, due to time limitations and the recognition that most respondents knew only a few organizations.

The second part of our data set relies on a document analysis to gain further information about the organizational context of the 102 nonprofit

brands. To examine the organization's accountability, mission, history, and size, we evaluated externally available data (DZI, 2014), including the web-pages and annual reports of all nonprofit organizations and documents that offer insights into the organization's accountability.

Measures

Trust evaluation: individual public's trust in NPO

Two main approaches were most often used to measure trust in organizations: (1) measurement of expectations and opinions about the trustworthiness, (2) measurement of trusting behaviors (Shamir & Lapidot, 2003, p. 469). In our case, the behavioral measurement approach is problematic because a typical characteristic of the general public is that there is no willingness to extra-role engagement with a specific nonprofit organization. We hence measured individual trust in an organization, using a scale developed by Sargeant and Woodliffe (2007), which is commonly used in nonprofit trust research. The trust variable was operationalized with three items in a reflective measure—(1) *I trust this organization to always act in the best interests of the cause.* (2) *I trust this organization to conduct its operations ethically.* (3) *I trust this organization to use donated funds appropriately*—using a 7-point Likert scale anchored at “strongly disagree” (1) and “strongly agree” (7). To assess the measurement quality of our main construct, we ran confirmatory factor analysis using AMOS. The results in Table 1 provide evidence of the measure's sound psychometric properties. The Cronbach's α value exceeds with .93 the recommended threshold value of .70, indicating high internal consistency variables (Nunnally & Bernstein, 1994). The composite reliability and average variance extracted also were with .93 and .82 above the suggested threshold values of .60 and .50, respectively (Bagozzi, Yi, & Phillips, 1991).

Individual context and determinants

To assess the individual context, we included several sociodemographic characteristics in the survey (see Table 1). Age was measured in years; gender was operationalized as a dummy variable (0 = female, 1 = male). For education, we used several categories, ranging from “no degree” to “PhD” at the highest level. Household size reflected the number of persons in the household. For income, we determined monthly net income in Euros, and we operationalized religion with a dummy to indicate if the respondent had any religious affiliation (0 = no religious affiliation, 1 = religious affiliation). Citizenship was another dummy variable, according to whether the respondent was of German nationality or not (0 = German, 1 = foreigner).

Table 1. Measurement items and descriptive analysis.

Trust Component		N	%	M	SD
Trust Evaluation: Individual Public's Trust in NPO [AVE = .82; CR = .93; α = 0.93]		4,072			
<i>(up to 3 comparative trust evaluations per individual)</i>					
I trust this nonprofit brand to always act in the best interests of the cause.				5.12	1.38
I trust this nonprofit brand to conduct its operations ethically.				5.13	1.37
I trust this nonprofit brand to use donated funds appropriately.				5.05	1.40
Individual Context and Determinants		1,686			
Sociodemographic Characteristics					
Age	14–19	152	9.02		
	20–29	300	17.79		
	30–39	284	16.84		
	40–49	382	22.66		
	50–59	401	23.78		
	60–64	167	9.91		
Gender	Female	845	50.12		
	Male	841	49.88		
Education	No degree/not yet a degree	98	5.81		
	Completed school education	418	24.79		
	Apprenticeship	772	45.79		
	Bachelor's/master's/diploma	350	20.76		
	MBA/PhD	48	2.85		
Household size	1 person	398	23.61		
	2 persons	577	34.22		
	3 persons	361	21.41		
	4 persons	251	14.89		
	5 persons	75	4.45		
	6 and more persons	24	1.42		
Monthly net income	No income	71	4.21		
	<1,000 euros	430	25.50		
	1,000–3,999 euros	927	54.98		
	> 4,000 euros	88	5.22		
	<i>Missing responses</i>	170	10.08		
Religion	Religious affiliation	898	53.26		
	No religious affiliation	788	46.74		
Citizenship	German	1,630	96.68		
	Foreigner	56	3.32		
Organizational Context and Determinants		102			
Accountability					
DZI Seal-of-Approval		42	41.18		
Mission focus ^A					
Disaster, development and social services		56	54.90		
Education		10	9.80		
Human rights		8	7.84		
Children		25	24.51		
Health and combating of life-threatening diseases		10	9.80		
Environment & animals		17	16.67		
Religion		21	20.59		
Other		16	15.69		
History and size					
Age				49.76	36.40
Total revenues (millions of Euros)				90	198
<i>Log (total revenues)</i>				7.28	0.84

M = mean; SD = standard deviation; AVE = average variance extracted; CR = composite reliability.

 α = Cronbach's alpha. ^A Organizations could be assigned to several mission categories.

Organizational context and determinants

At the organizational level, we measured accountability according to whether the organization carries the so-called “DZI Seal-of-Approval”, using a dummy variable (0 = no DZI in 2014, 1 = DZI in 2014). The DZI Seal-of-Approval is a Germany-wide renowned accreditation and widely regarded as a strong quality signal that the nonprofit organization deals carefully and responsibly with funds it receives (DZI, 2014), with an appropriate amount of overall overhead cost (not higher than 30% of a raised Euro). As such, it constitutes an important quality label for organizations from the nonprofit sector to show their transparency and increase public trust. We measured the organization’s mission focus with several dummy variables, categorizing the wide variety of possible missions following the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (United Nations, 2019) (0 = not fitting this mission category, 1 = fitting this mission category). Table 1 contains a list of the measurement items and variables, as well as their descriptive statistics. Each nonprofit organization had at least one specific mission focus and fit a specific mission category, but it also could be assigned to several categories. Finally, we measured the history of the organization in years since its founding, and we used the organization’s total revenues (mainly from 2013) to quantify its size. Because normal distribution was not reached, data relating to total revenues were log-transformed.

Data analysis

In our conceptual framework, public trust is the dependent variable, which is influenced by determinants from both the individual and organizational context. The multitude of comparative trust evaluations (at level 1) creates an appropriate data structure for performing a multilevel analysis of trust of various organizations by individuals (Gonzalez-Roma & Hernandez, 2017; Kozlowski & Klein, 2000). Herein, the dependent variable of public trust is nested in the individual and organizational context, which represents the multilevel, or more precisely the cross-level, structure of our data set.

To address our two research questions, we took a step-wise approach to the data analysis. First, we specified the levels at which public trust in nonprofit organizations is situated and verified if significant variances occur at each of the three levels (level 1, and contextual levels 2a and 2b). In this process, we calculated the intra-class correlation (ICC 1), which expresses the relative proportion of level variances by calculating the proportion of significant variance at the organizational or individual contextual level, compared with the overall variance of the individual public’s trust in NPO. The calculation of the ICC 1 values is based on null models without fixed-effect independent variables. ICC accordingly depicts the amount of significant contextual level variance, divided by the amount of

residual variance for the dependent variable. In the context of effectiveness, ICC has been frequently used to quantify within-group agreement (Boyer & Verma, 2000), yet its use is not limited to the agreement function and can be used also in other contexts (Rasbash, Charlton, Browne, Healy, & Cameron, 2005). It follows that with these calculations, we can test which level in our framework explains most. Thus, we are able to answer H1, H2, and H3.

Second, we analyzed the specific cross-level effects with a multilevel regression analysis. More generally speaking, we assessed if and which individual and organizational determinants were influencing the individual's trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization. Herein, a multilevel approach is appropriate because it allows for the simultaneous examination of the effects between variables on different levels. Using these considerations, we tested the hypotheses with two separate multilevel regression analyses, one for each cross-level combination (with MLwiN: Rasbash et al., 2005). Although similar results could be obtained from a single, integrated analysis, such as a nonhierarchical multilevel structure (MCMC approach in Rasbash et al., 2005), we decided to report the two separate analyses, because the main findings do not differ, but with this approach, we could adopt a much broader, accepted, and standardized estimation (including the reporting format).

For the first regression analysis, the 4,072 trust evaluations are nested in 1,686 individuals, and we include individual determinants reflecting their age, gender, education, household size, income, religion, and citizenship. With this analysis, we test Hypothesis 4. Then, in the second analysis, the 4,072 trust assessments are nested in 102 nonprofit organizations, and we include the organizational determinants – accreditation, mission, and history and size. This analysis relates to the test of Hypothesis 5a-c.

Results

Descriptives

Table 2 shows the results for the 40 most trusted nonprofit brands ranked by the mean value of the trust evaluation. In the ranking, only nonprofit brands with more than 20 evaluations are shown, and the list, therefore, does not imply any claim to completeness for the German nonprofit sector. The descriptive results indicate that with a mean value of 5.58, the German José Carreras Leukemia Foundation had the highest public trust value within the selected sample of 40 organizations. Additional high-scoring nonprofit brands are the Children's Missionary Organization "Sternsinger" [5.56], German Society of Multiple Sclerosis [5.55], German Leukemia Research Aid – Initiative for Children with Cancer [5.54], Aktion Lichtblicke [5.53], German Emergency Doctors [5.50], Herzenswünsche [5.48], German AIDS

Table 2. Top 40 most trusted nonprofit brands in Germany.

Nonprofit brand names (English translation, if suitable)	N Evaluation ^a	Public trust (Mean)
1 German José Carreras Leukemia Foundation	152	5.58
2 Children's Missionary Organization "Sternsinger"	72	5.56
3 German Society of Multiple Sclerosis	65	5.55
4 German Leukemia Research Aid – Initiative for Children with Cancer	119	5.54
5 Aktion Lichtblicke	93	5.53
6 German Emergency Doctors	215	5.50
7 Herzenswünsche	58	5.48
8 German AIDS Foundation	23	5.48
9 German Association for Child Protection	289	5.42
10 Karl Heinz Böhm Foundation	107	5.34
11 Schweitzer Children's Village	39	5.28
12 v. Bodelschwingh Institutions Bethel	95	5.27
13 Hamburger Tafel	32	5.26
14 Federal Association for People with Intellectual Disabilities	336	5.24
15 Worldwide Help for Children	44	5.19
16 German Red Cross	40	5.13
17 German Foundation for Monument Protection	87	5.12
18 German Committee for UNICEF	41	5.12
19 Kindernothilfe	25	5.12
20 Robert Bosch Foundation	20	5.12
21 Children's Fund for Children in the Third World	128	5.10
22 ChildFund Germany	36	5.10
23 RTL Children in Need Foundation	102	5.01
24 German Children's Fund	39	5.00
25 WEISSER RING	22	4.98
26 BILD helps "A Heart for Children"	336	4.95
27 Aktion Mensch	21	4.95
28 CARE Germany-Luxembourg	113	4.94
29 Int. Conf. f. Youth/Social Work, Education/Labor Market Services	56	4.92
30 German War Graves Commission	76	4.91
31 German Heart Foundation	46	4.87
32 Aktion Deutschland Hilft	41	4.85
33 ADVENIAT	53	4.81
34 McDonald's Children's Charity	20	4.75
35 Diakonie Katastrophenhilfe	37	4.75
36 Kolping Society of Germany	205	4.72
37 German Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA)	259	4.70
38 The social welfare organization of Germany's Protestant churches	21	4.70
39 Greenpeace	27	4.67
40 German National Academic Foundation	27	4.58

^aOnly nonprofit brands with more than 20 evaluations are shown in this ranking. The list, therefore, does not imply any claim to completeness.

Foundation [5.48], German Association for Child Protection [5.42], and Karl Heinz Böhm Foundation [5.34].

The descriptive results provide a first direction toward which of the organizational determinants might be relevant in the context of public trust. The results indicate that particularly nonprofit organizations with a mission focus on health and combating of life-threatening diseases or a mission focus on children score comparatively high on public trust. Regarding accountability, and accreditation in particular, the descriptive

Table 3. Results on importance of levels.

Level		Intraclass correlation (ICC 1)	
		Level 1 compared to Level 2a	Level 1 compared to Level 2b
Level 2a	Individual context	50.91%***	
Level 1	Individual public's trust in NPO	49.09%***	93.62%***
Level 2b	Organizational context		6.38%***

*** $p < .001$.

results show that nine out of the 10 most trusted nonprofit brands are accredited by an external institution, and carry the “DZI Seal-of-Approval”. With respect to the organizational history and size, the highest-ranking nonprofit brands range from 17 to 169 years, with revenues in the scope between 1,416 thousand Euros and 70,443 thousand Euros.

Importance of three different components for explaining public's trust

To test the importance of each trust component (or more precisely level) in comparison to one another, we first appraised the respective ICC 1 values for both levels, respectively, and tested for their significance (both ICC 1 values were significant with $p < .001$). To discern the importance of each level, we then focused on the size of the ICC 1 values. For the first analysis, in which trust evaluations were nested within individuals, the results show that 49.09% relates to the individual's trust evaluations in one of the three possible nonprofit organizations, whereas 50.91% of variance is situated at the individual context. For the second analysis, in which trust evaluations were nested within organizations, only 6.38% of the variance is situated at the organizational context, and 93.62% refers to the individual public's trust in a nonprofit organization. Given the comparatively high ICC 1 values of 49.09% and 93.62%, public trust in a nonprofit organization depends mostly on the specific relationship between the individual and the organization, and is thus based on a multitude of individual opinions toward the nonprofit organization. It follows that Hypothesis 1 is confirmed. Additionally, the individual context does not only influence the individual trust evaluation, but plays a major role for explaining public trust and therewith Hypothesis 2 is supported by the data. In contrast, the organizational context is least relevant, yet significant, for explaining public trust. It follows that Hypothesis 3 is also supported by the data. Table 3 provides an overview of the results of this analysis.

Table 4. Results of the multilevel regression analysis.

Level 2a Independent Variables	Individual Determinants	Level 2b Independent Variables	Organizational Determinants
	Public Trust		Public Trust
Intercept	0.818***	Intercept	1.042***
Sociodemographic Characteristics		Accountability	
Age	0.089***	Accreditation	0.202*
Gender	-0.168**	Mission Focus	
		Disaster, development & social services	0.011
Education	0.032		
Household size	0.084***	Education	-0.194
Monthly net income	-0.049*	Human rights	-0.012
Religion	0.081	Children	0.165*
Citizenship	0.258	Health & combating of life- threatening diseases	0.177
		Environment & animals	-0.124
		Religion	-0.386***
		History & Size	
		Age	0.002*
		Log(total revenues)	-0.029
Fit Statistics:			
$\Delta\chi^2$ (d.f. = 10)	$\Delta\chi^2 = 31.489***$	$\Delta\chi^2$ (d.f. = 7)	$\Delta\chi^2 = 1,288.273***$

* $p < .05$; ** $p < .01$; *** $p < .001$. Note: N = 4,072 trust evaluations from N = 1,686 respondents, relating to N = 102 nonprofit organizations.

Influence of individual and organizational determinants on public's trust

Table 4 provides an overview of the results of the multilevel regression analysis. Noting the change in the $-2\log$ likelihood, we chose the alternative models, over the null models, because they provided a significant model improvement in the chi-square test ($p < .001$) (Rasbash et al., 2005). With respect to the hypothesized cross-level effects, we found some significant individual and organizational determinants, in general support of our proposition that both contexts are relevant and that public trust in nonprofit organizations depends on these determinants, at different levels.

The results for the individual context model identify four significant socio-demographic characteristics: age, gender, household size, and income. Older persons express more trust (.089; $p < .001$), and men, compared with women, score lower in their trust ($-.168$; $p < .01$). Households with more members, such as families or flat-sharing communities, trust more (.084; $p < .001$). Finally, income has a significant effect on trust, such that low-income people trust more ($-.049$; $p < .05$). In contrast, for citizenship, education levels, and religion, we find no noteworthy effects. It follows that Hypothesis 4 is (partially) supported by the data.

In the results for the organizational context, we find that the organizational determinants, namely accountability, mission, as well as history and size all

influence public trust in nonprofit organizations. Precisely, the accreditation, DZI Seal-of-Approval, has a significant influence on trust (.202; $p < .05$). Several mission categories score higher than others; in particular, nonprofit organizations that focus on children in their missions are significantly more trusted than others (.165; $p < .05$). However, organizations with a religious mission are comparatively less trusted by the general public than organizations without such a focus (−.386; $p < .001$). The history of a nonprofit organization also relates to the public's trust (.002; $p < .05$). This effect is small but still relevant, in that some organizations are more than a century old. Finally, we find no noteworthy effects of the organization's total revenues. To sum up, Hypotheses 5a-c are thus supported by the data. Table 5 provides an overview of all hypotheses supported.

Concluding discussion and future research

Overall, the key findings of our study reveal considerable differences in the importance of the different trust-building components, or levels, for explaining the public's trust. Given the comparatively high ICC 1 values of 49.09% and 93.62%, public trust in a nonprofit organization depends mostly on the specific relationship between the individual and the nonprofit organization. This might stem from the fact that a person's trust evaluation mainly builds from characteristics of his or her actual trust relationship and experiences he or she has with each single organization. This view is widely supported in trust research, given the high importance of trust at the so-called individual level (Fulmer & Gelfand, 2012).

However, with an ICC 1 value of 50.91%, a person's individual background appears to determine assessments of the trustworthiness of a nonprofit organization substantially. It follows that when a person evaluates several relationships with different organizations; his or her background influences such evaluations similarly. The high importance of the individual context for the public's trust might be due to the fact that trust varies widely according to each person's characteristic qualities (see also Lewicki, Tomlinson, & Gillespie, 2006). Our results are based on an investigation of mostly sociodemographic characteristics, and we found age, gender, income, and household size to be relevant as older, female, and low-income people and those from larger households are more likely to trust nonprofit organizations. Yet, given the comparatively high ICC 1 values of 49.09% versus 50.91; the public's trust is nearly equally based on a multitude of individual beliefs and expectations toward the organization.

The varying effects among people's sociodemographic characteristics regarding their interactions in trustful relationships might stem from different mechanisms such as solicitation, value, cost mechanisms, and awareness of need that work differently among persons. In the context of pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations, and philanthropic behavior, in particular, existent studies typically show a positive relationship with age (for an extensive literature overview, see Bekkers & Wiepking, 2011). While there is no certain agreement about the

Table 5. Overview of hypotheses supported.

Research Questions		Hypotheses		H supported
RQ1	How is trust among the general public, and which components are most important to explain public's trust in nonprofit organizations?	H1	The <i>individual trust evaluation</i> has the largest influence on the public's trust in a nonprofit organization, compared to the individual (trustor) and the organizational (trustee) context.	Yes
		H2	The <i>individual (trustor) context</i> has a positive influence on the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes
		H3	The <i>organizational (trustee) context</i> has a positive influence on the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes
RQ2	Which of the individual and organizational determinants explain the public's trust in a nonprofit organization most?	H4	<i>Individual determinants</i> in the form of sociodemographics influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes
		H5a	<i>Organizational determinants</i> in the form of (a) accountability influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes
		H5b	<i>Organizational determinants</i> in the form of (b) mission influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes
		H5c	<i>Organizational determinants</i> in the form of (c) history & size influence the individual trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization.	Yes

correlation of specific age ranges and pro-social behavior, most studies find that older individuals are typically more pro-socially engaged, while this effect decreases at higher ages; due to life-cycle or cohort effects. Regarding gender, existent empirical studies show varying results; some confirming our study's results in that women are more like to engage in pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations (e.g., with regard to giving or volunteering behavior, see Einolf, 2011). Rhoads (2005) argues that women tend to have a greater capacity when it comes to the principle of care, empathic concern and higher prosocial values, yet, little is known about the underlying mechanisms (De Wit & Bekkers, 2016).

The relationship between income and pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations, and giving behavior, in particular, has been of large study interest, showing a positive relationship between wealth and the amount donated. When it comes to trusting behavior, little is known about the rationale of low-income individuals trusting more. One possible mechanism might relate to the awareness of need, given that an individual's sense of affinity with other low-income individuals being targeted by the nonprofit organization might impact his or her trusting behavior. In the context of giving behavior, Bennett (2012) finds the sense of an individual's affinity with other low-income individuals and general beliefs about how unfairly society treats the poor exerted significant impacts on giving behavior; whereas this effect was influenced by the person's educational level. Lastly, individuals from larger households tend to pose higher levels of trust toward nonprofit organizations. Large households usually contain (more) children, and having children increases the awareness of need, and families are also more likely exposed to solicited offers (Wiepking & Bekkers, 2012).

Moreover, with an ICC 1 value of 6.38%, our study reveals less relative importance of the organizational context regarding public's trust. It follows that each organizational context influences trustors only on a small scale in a similar way. One reason for this effect might be that nonprofit organizations, compared to commercial business or public organizations, possess per se higher trust values (Edelman, 2019), and nonprofit organizations' perception relating to trustworthiness is rather similar among the general public. Within the context of low organizational context relevance, we found that well-established organizations, and organizations with a specific mission as well as those that are accredited, achieve comparatively higher levels of trust. This might stem from the fact that well-established organizations have generated greater awareness and familiarity among the public which results in higher trust. Besides, the importance of the respective nonprofit organization's mission, and particularly when it relates to supporting children's welfare, may stem from mechanisms such as higher awareness of need, higher solicitation, or greater consistency between the individual's and organization's values. Lastly, accreditation and other attempts to show a nonprofit organization's transparency and trustworthiness might be important for the general public as such certificates reduce risks in trustful exchange

relationships, and thus help trustors to weigh up cost and benefits regarding entering such relationships.

Research implications

As a point of departure, this study complements and specifies undifferentiated notions in previous research about the public's trust in nonprofit organizations, and beyond that, in organizations in general. Thereby, our study offers a more complex perspective on trust and contributes to trust research in three main ways. First, although nonprofit organizations depend particularly on trust, the academic discussion is rather unilateral, largely focusing on a single stakeholder group. Compared to mainly donor trust, public trust has been only focused on more recently. Considering its increasing practical relevance, more scholars are starting to investigate the public's trust in nonprofit organizations. Still, from the few studies, most investigations take a conceptual perspective (e.g., Bryce, 2007; O'Neill, 2009), or focus on the rather dominant organizational context (Farwell et al., 2018; Furneaux & Wymer, 2015). In contrast, we provide empirical insights into the trust-building processes among the general public, including both trust parties' context. As our results show, public trust essentially demands a broad and more comprehensive perspective, revealing that this complex phenomenon emerges not just from a single determinant but rather results from the interaction of multiple causes.

This leads to our second contribution, the investigation of public trust in nonprofit organizations from a so-called multilevel perspective. To the best of our knowledge, this study is the first to address, conceptually and empirically, the issue of trust in nonprofit organizations across different levels of analysis. In line with other studies (e.g., Jones & Shah, 2015; Schilke & Cook, 2013), our study offers empirical evidence, gathered from a large sample of individuals and nonprofit organizations in Germany, that the public's trust in nonprofit organizations is situated at different levels and that certain contextual determinants are relevant to this trust. The trust concept thus should not be limited to a single conceptual or operational level. Several levels in combination can be relevant. As the public's trust in nonprofit organizations depends mostly on the specific relationship between the individual and the nonprofit organization, this finding has major methodological and conceptual consequences for studies that focus on trust as an organizational-level construct. Multiple individual opinions are needed to assess public trust in an organization, and specific relational and individual elements need to be considered to develop a full, thorough understanding of an organization's trustworthiness. Yet few trust studies use multilevel investigations, or explicitly examine trust in individual and organizational contexts (Jones & Shah, 2015). Our findings among other studies from organizational science, in turn, highlight the need for in-depth analyses (see also, Fulmer & Gelfand, 2012; Mayer, Davis, & Schoorman, 1995).

Third, in nonprofit management and marketing research, organizational efforts to build and restore public trust are prominent. Besides the organizational context, the importance of individual characteristics for pro-social behavior toward nonprofit organizations has been highlighted. Little is known about the interrelation between these contextual components and the public trust evaluations, and most previous studies focus on the latter component alone. The expectations at this level support the subjective nature of trust, as it is embedded in attribution and social identity theories. Both these theories also are context dependent, such that different findings and propositions likely arise from different contexts. We clarify how some contextual elements explain this diversity. Further research also could incorporate more details about specific backgrounds and context while applying attribution and social identity theories to nonprofit organizations.

Managerial implications

The study results provide bases for some useful recommendations for managers and marketers of all kinds of organizations, but nonprofit organizations in particular. A key recommendation is that nonprofit marketers should regard public trust as a complex entity, influenced by determinants on several levels. To capture the full potential of efforts to increase public trust in their organizations, marketers should apply a more integrated approach in practice, with tactics at both the organizational and individual contextual levels. Noting the low variance in the organizational context and the widely varying individual opinions about any single nonprofit organization, marketers should take sociodemographic characteristics into account and refrain from applying any one-size-fits-all strategy to increase trust.

At the organizational contextual level, our findings suggest that accreditation that indicates the transparency and trustworthiness of nonprofit organizations can increase trust in those. Therefore, nonprofit organizations should apply for the DZI Seal-of-Approval or corresponding seals and certificates in other nations. For nonprofit organizations whose mission relates to children's welfare, marketers should highlight the mission in their marketing efforts. Similarly, if the nonprofit organization has been well established and reached an advanced age, this status should be communicated to the public. This organizational context thus offers a range of trust-building actions, but they are relatively less important than the factors that constitute the individual context. We recommend that nonprofit marketers carefully consider whether to devote effort, financial resources, and time to apply for certificates or develop new marketing campaigns.

Finally, at the individual contextual level, nonprofit marketers should recognize the potential benefits of segmenting their stakeholder groups. In particular, they should consider how to develop targeted marketing campaigns for different stakeholders that will increase their trust in the

organizations. A sociodemographic segmentation should focus mainly on individual stakeholders' ages, gender, net income, and household size. The stakeholder groups that exhibit the greatest potential are younger men, wealthy people, and those from single-person households.

Limitations and further research

Some limitations of this study suggest directions for further research, beyond those indicated by our findings. First, we find that the individual context is highly relevant for explaining trust in nonprofit organizations, because 50.91% of variance relates to this level. But this study focuses on socio-demographic characteristics at the individual level, so we cannot explain all the variance. That is, we identify the importance of this level but can only account for one relevant contextual component, such that we were forced to neglect others. Recent studies, for example, highlighted the relevance of trust contextualization within broader social and institutional trust (Farwell et al., 2018; Hager & Hedberg, 2016), in that each trust evaluation of a nonprofit organization is influenced by these broader forms of trust. Further research could include additional variables at this level, such as an individual's unique trust-related and psychographic characteristics.

Second, nonprofit organizations with religious missions are comparatively less trusted by the general public than organizations without such a mission (coefficient = -0.386). At first glance, this strong effect may seem surprising, especially because many nonprofit organizations operate in affiliation with churches and other religious organizations (Weisbrod, 1988). We posit that a series of church scandals in Germany might have created negative spillover effects on church-related organizations. In addition, differences between the general public and certain stakeholder groups might result in different effects; for example, people with a religious background reacted differently to a nonprofit organization with a religious mission than those with a non-religious background. This finding is interesting for further research; a thorough investigation was beyond the scope of this study. We encourage researchers to investigate the fit between individual and organizational contextual elements, by examining specific individual–organizational trust matches. These limitations and avenues for research together indicate the relevance of additional studies on trust in various contexts; we consider it a very promising area for trust research. This initial evidence should, we hope, stimulate and contribute to the much needed discussion about an integrated view of trust in nonprofit organizations.

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Appendix

Organization sample and corresponding contextual characteristics (N = 102)

Nonprofit brand names (English translation, if suitable)		DZI ^a	Mission ^b	Age ^c	Rev ^d
1	Aktion Deutschland Hilft	1	a	4	82,511
2	Aktion Lichtblicke	1	d	17	3,923
3	Aktion Mensch	0	d	51	46,018
4	Animal Welfare Association Arche 90	0	f	25	254,000
5	Attac Association	0	c	12	n.a.
6	Bible TV Foundation	0	gh	14	9,017
7	BILD helps "A Heart for Children"	0	d	37	19,068
8	Bread for the World – Protestant Development Service	1	ag	56	263,385
9	CARE Germany-Luxembourg	0	a	35	25,587
10	Charity Aid to the Church in Need	1	g	68	9,036
11	ChildFund Germany	1	ad	37	7,978
12	Children's Fund for Children in the Third World	1	ad	40	512,000
13	Children's Missionary Organization "Sternsinger"	1	adg	169	70,443
14	Diakonie Katastrophenhilfe	1	ag	63	61,446
15	Engineers Without Borders	0	a	12	679,000
16	Episcopal Campaign ADVENIAT	1	ag	54	38,408
17	Episcopal Relief Organization Misereor	1	ag	57	178,200
18	Federal Agency for Technical Relief	0	af	65	178,800
19	Federal Association for People with Intellectual Disabilities	1	a	57	10,038
20	Federal Association for the Protection of Animals	0	f	53	536,000
21	Federal Foundation for the Environment	0	f	25	134,203
22	foodwatch	0	c	13	2,033
23	Four Paws	0	f	27	13,117
24	Friends of the Earth Germany (BUND)	0	f	40	19,406
25	Fundraising Group of Mary's sisters	1	adg	41	15,888
26	General German Automobile Club	0	ah	112	949,746
27	German Academic Exchange Service	0	b	90	469,662
28	German Agro Action	1	a	53	152,412
29	German AIDS Foundation	1	e	28	2,299
30	German Animal Welfare Association	1	f	134	24,053
31	German Association for Child Protection	0	cd	62	1,467
32	German Association for Nature Conservation	0	f	116	31,725
33	German Bone Marrow Donor Center	0	e	24	9,985
34	German Cancer Aid	0	e	41	81,100
35	German Caritas Association	1	ag	28	138,943
36	German Children's Fund	0	cd	43	5,995
37	German Committee for AIESEC	0	b	59	n.a.
38	German Committee for UNICEF	1	acd	62	96,869
39	German Emergency Doctors	1	a	36	3,664
40	German Federal Association of Dinner Tables	1	a	20	6,111
41	German Foundation for Monument Protection	0	h	30	41,573
42	German Foundation for World Population	1	a	24	6,720
43	German Heart Foundation	0	e	36	10,196
44	German José Carreras Leukemia Foundation	1	e	20	n.a.
45	German Leukemia Research Aid – Initiative for Children with Cancer	1	de	20	11,904
46	German Maritime Search and Rescue Service	1	aeh	150	40,606
47	German National Academic Foundation	0	b	90	79,221

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Nonprofit brand names (English translation, if suitable)	DZI ^a	Mission ^b	Age ^c	Rev ^d
48 German National Association of Worldshops	0	afh	40	877,000
49 German Red Cross	1	ac	94	136,195
50 German Section of amnesty international	0	c	54	17,396
51 German Society of Multiple Sclerosis	1	e	63	1,416
52 German UNESCO commission	0	bh	65	n.a.
53 German War Graves Commission	0	ah	96	29,499
54 German Young Men's Christian Association YMCA)	1	g	133	10,031
55 Greenpeace	0	f	35	54,582
56 Hamburger Tafel	0	a	21	n.a.
57 Hans Böckler Foundation	0	b	38	65,000
58 Heinrich Böll Foundation	0	cf	29	51,562
59 Hermann-Gmeiner-Fonds – SOS Children's VillagesWorldwide	1	adg	52	137,497
60 Herzenswünsche	1	d	23	1,693
61 Hinz&Kunzt gemeinnützige Verlags- und Vertriebs GmbH	0	a	22	1,963
62 Int. Conf. f. Youth/Social Work, Education/Labor Market Services	0	abh	66	514,800
63 International Fund for Animal Welfare	0	f	29	10,069
64 Islamic Relief Germany	0	ag	19	15,271
65 Karl Heinz Böhm Foundation	1	a	34	9,346
66 Kindernothilfe	1	ad	56	58,229
67 Kolping Society of Germany	0	ag	13	n.a.
68 Konferenz für Kirchliche Bahnhofsmission	0	ag	105	n.a.
69 Konrad Adenauer Foundation	0	abgh	60	136,035
70 Maltese Charity Service	0	ag	62	284,786
71 McDonald's Children's Charity	1	de	28	13,036
72 Michael Stich Foundation	0	e	21	n.a.
73 OXFAM Germany	1	a	20	8,508
74 Paritätisches Bildungswerk Bundesverband	0	ab	51	n.a.
75 PETA Germany	0	f	22	4,173
76 Plan International Germany	1	ad	26	324,629
77 Red Aid	0	h	40	n.a.
78 Robert Bosch Foundation	0	bh	51	98,272
79 ROBIN WOOD	0	f	33	960,000
80 Rosa Luxemburg Foundation	0	bh	25	43,280
81 RTL Children in Need Foundation	1	ad	18	15,344
82 Salvation Army in Germany	1	ag	150	21,324
83 Save the Children Germany	1	ad	11	15,848
84 Schweitzer Children's Village	0	ad	58	2,180
85 SOS Children's Villages	1	adg	60	254,673
86 St. John Ambulance Brigade	1	adg	63	703,102
87 TERRA MATER	0	f	19	1,640
88 terre des hommes Germany	1	ad	48	22,033
89 The social welfare organization of Germany's Protestant churches	0	ag	166	n.a.
90 Transfair, Society for the Promotion of Fair Trade with Third World	0	ah	23	7,337
91 Transparency International Germany	0	h	22	355,000
92 UN Refugee Aid Organization	1	a	35	9,371
93 v. Bodelschwingh Institutions Bethel	0	a	148	4,181
94 Viva con Agua de Sankt Pauli	0	f	9	1,248
95 Voluntary Fire Brigade	0	ah	n.a.	n.a.
96 WEISSER RING	0	ah	39	18,554
97 Worker's Samaritan Association of Germany	0	a	106	1,285,263
98 Workers Welfare	0	a	17	4,583
99 World Vision Germany	1	adg	36	80,466
100 World Wide Fund for Nature Germany	0	f	52	64,080

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Nonprofit brand names (English translation, if suitable)		DZI ^a	Mission ^b	Age ^c	Rev ^d
101	Worldwide Help for Children	0	ad	44	n.a.
102	wünschdirwas	1	ad	26	n.a.

Notes: German NPO names are available on request; n.a. = data not available.

^aOrganizations that carried the “DZI Seal-of-Approval” in 2014 indicated with “1”.

^bOrganizational mission focus: (a) disaster, development and social services, (b) education, (c) human rights, (d) children, (e) health and combating of life-threatening diseases, (f) environment and animals, (g) religion, (h) other.

^cAge of the organization in years since its founding.

^dOrganization’s total revenues (mainly from 2013) in thousand Euros.